

The Important Book

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Source: `the\_important\_book\_margaret\_wise\_brown\_z\_library\_sk,\_1lib\_sk,.pdf`
(32 PDF pages; story on PDF pages 2-27 and 31)

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> Internal school working copy prepared from a school-accessible PDF. Keep with the restricted book files. Do not publish this transcript in GitHub, Supabase, or the public progress viewer.

The important thing about a cricket is that it is black.
It chirps, it hops, it jumps, and sings all through the summer night,
But the important thing about a cricket is that it is black.
(you tell me)

The important thing about grass
is that it is green.
It grows.
It grows.
It grows.
It grows.
It gives you a place to sit and think
and dream. It's green when it rains,
It bends in the wind,
It feels good under your feet.
But the important thing about grass
is that it is green.

The important thing
about an apple tree is
that the blossoms fall
and the apples are red.
They are sweet.
They are crisp, and red, and
the juice runs when you bite them.
But the important thing about
an apple tree is that it is green.

The important thing
about a spoon
is that it holds
what you are going
to put
in your mouth.
It is round
and it can
stand
alone.
But the important
thing about a spoon

is that it holds
what you are going
to put
in your mouth.

The important thing about a daisy
is that it is white.
It is yellow in the middle,
it has long white petals,
and bees sit on it,
it has a ticklish smell,
it grows in green fields,
and there are always lots of daisies.
But the important thing about a daisy
is that it is white.

The important thing about rain is that it is wet.
It falls out of the sky, and it sounds like rain,
and makes things shiny, and it does not taste like anything,
But the important thing about rain is that it is wet.

The important thing about snow
is that it is white.
It is cold, and light,
it falls softly out of the sky,
it is bright, and the shape of
tiny stars and crystals.
It is always cold.
And it melts.
But the important thing
about the snow is
that it is white.

The important thing about an apple
is that it is round.
It is red.
You bite it
and it is white inside,
and the juice splashes in your face
and it tastes like an apple
and it falls off a tree.
But the important
thing about
an apple is
that it is
round.

The important
thing about the
wind is that it

blows. You can't
see it, but you
can feel it on
your cheek,
and see it bend
trees, and blow hats
away, and sail boats.

The important thing about a shoe is that you put your foot in it.
You walk in it and you take it off at night
and it's warm when you take it off.
But the important thing about a shoe is that you put your foot in it.

The important thing about you is
that you are you.

It is true that you were a baby,
and you grew,
and now you are a child,
and you will grow,
into a man,
or into a woman.

But the important thing about you
is that
you
are
you

The important thing about --is that you let your child tell you what is important
about the sun and the moon and the wind and the rain
and a bug and a bee and a chair and a table
and a pencil and a bear and a rainbow and a cat (if he wants to).
For the important thing about THE IMPORTANT BOOK
is that the book goes on long after it is closed.

- Each stanza spreads a single bold refrain ("the important thing about ... is ...") across full-bleed illustration, with the closing spread addressing the parent directly.
- The stanzas run: cricket, grass, apple tree, spoon, daisy, rain, snow, apple, wind, shoe, you, then the closing.
- Weisgard's illustrations pair each defining trait with a cascade of sensory details; several spreads (spoons, daisies, rain, apple still-life, clouds, endpapers) carry illustration only.
- The dust jacket carries the title, author and illustrator credits with a miniature of the cricket page inviting the child to supply the refrain ("you tell me").
- Page map: text on PDF pages 2 (cricket), 4 (grass), 6 (apple tree), 9 (spoon), 10 (daisy), 12 and 14 (rain), 16-17 and 21 (snow), 18 (apple), 20 (wind), 22 and 24-25 (shoe), 26-27 (you), 31 (closing). Illustration-only: pages 5, 8, 11, 13, 15, 19, 23. Blank endpapers: 28-30. Jacket matter: page 1. Library due slip: page 3. Title page: page 7.
- Line breaks follow the printed layout, including the staggered refrains and the script "you / are / you" close.

- The wind stanza has no closing refrain in print -- it ends with "sail boats."
- The closing keeps the book's printed spacing ("about --is that").
- An early note about a "sky" stanza was an error and has been removed: no sky text exists anywhere in this scan.

Every story page was read visually against 150-200 dpi renders on 9 September 2026; the story text above is high confidence. Jacket matter (page 1), the library due slip (page 3), and the title page (page 7) are not included as story prose.